

Lemon/Blackberry Tarts

Wednesday, July 9, 2025

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Ingredients

FOR THE TART CRUST

- 1 1/4 cup all-purpose flour
- 1 stick butter
- 1/4 tsp. salt
- 1/4 cup sugar
- 1/2 an egg (1/2 egg white + 1/2 egg yolk)

FOR THE CUSTARD

- 2 cups milk
- 4 egg yolks
- 1/4 tsp. vanilla
- 3 tbsp. cornstarch
- 1 tbsp. butter
- 2 drops lemon flavoring/lemon oil

TOPPINGS

- Blackberries
- Powdered sugar (optional)

Instructions

- Using a stand mixer or hand mixer, mix together your flour, sugar, salt.
- Add the egg and then your butter and mix until it forms a dough. (using a dough attachment is ideal for this).
- Cover the dough with cling wrap and refrigerate for 30-45 minutes.
- Pour your milk into a pot and set the heat to medium.
- Add the egg yolks one at a time and stir after you pour each one.
- After you have mixed in all of your egg yolks, add your sugar and vanilla.
- Add in 1-2 drops of lemon oil/flavoring. You can substitute this by using lemon zest extracted from one whole lemon.
- Put in your cornstarch and whisk. You will notice that the mixture is getting thicker.
- Finally, incorporate your butter into the custard. Take off of heat.
- Using a sieve, remove any large lumps in the custard. This will ensure that the custard is smooth.
- Cover the custard with cling wrap, lightly pressing onto the surface of the custard to prevent a skin from forming. Refrigerator for one hour.
- Once the dough is done sitting in the fridge, roll it out between two sheets of parchment paper. You can prevent it from sticking further by sprinkling the parchment sheets with flour.
- Cover your tart mold with the dough and press on it until the dough is cut out into the shape of your mold. Repeat with the rest of your molds until you do not have any dough left.
- Poke the dough around the mold (about 5-6 times) and bake at 350 degrees for 15 minutes.
- Using a piping bag or spoon, fill in the tart shells with the custard.
- Decorate the top with blackberries and dust with powdered sugar (optional).

Tips

- Before serving, I highly recommend refrigerating the tarts for at least 25 minutes. Tarts are best eaten chilled.
- Since the tart crust is being blind-baked, it is important that you prick the base of it with a fork. This will prevent air from getting trapped in the crust and ultimately the crust from rising.
- If you notice that the edges are becoming lightly browned/golden brown, take it out of the oven! The time it takes to bake a tart crust is up to your situation: the size of your tart pan, the type of tart pan you use, the heat settings on your oven, etc. The timing for taking it out of the oven is around 15 minutes so as long as it is near that time, you will be good to go!